

people had special talents or skills, they wouldn't be special anymore. They would be common.

What you can do is develop a “talent stack,” a term coined by Scott Adams, creator of the comic strip *Dilbert*, in his book *How to Fail at Almost Anything and Still Win Big*. Most of us do not have the natural ability to become world class at any particular thing. However, with effort and determination, nearly anyone can be among the top 10 to 20 percent of the population in just about anything they put their minds to. Once you develop competencies, you can connect them to create a unique skill set.

Talent stacks aren't usually the result of starting with a “master plan” and executing it to perfection. They often come together in serendipitous ways. They are a result of the principles discussed earlier in this chapter: starting with a growth mindset, committing to being a lifelong learner, and aggregating marginal gains over time.

Jonathan

What is the story you tell yourself about yourself? I believe I'm the type of person who can learn anything. Every time I tackle something new, it starts with a question. My 2016 started with “How do I start a podcast?”